

A

Hotel facilities and rooms

¹ centre² staff will bring food and drink to the room³ use of the Internet⁴ a system that keeps the air cool⁵ a room for one person⁶ a room for two people with one big bed⁷ a room for two people with two beds⁸ TV with many channels from different countries⁹ a small fridge¹⁰ a box to keep money and valuable items in

B

Staying in a hotel

Rooms are often **available**¹ during the week, but many hotels are **fully booked**² at weekends or during the holidays, so you may need to **book a room**³ **in advance**⁴. When you arrive, you **check in at reception**⁵; at the end of your **stay**⁶, you **check out**⁷.

¹ you can find one² all the rooms are taken³ arrange/plan to have a room; *syn* **reserve**⁴ before you go⁵ say you have arrived and get your room key⁶ the period of time you spend in a place⁷ pay your bill and leave the hotel

C

Going to a restaurant

It's often a good idea to **book a table / make a reservation** if you go to a restaurant at the weekend. Many restaurants offer **three-course** meals which **include** [have as part of the meal] a **starter** (e.g. soup), **main course** (e.g. meat or fish) and **dessert** (e.g. fruit with ice cream). Prices sometimes include 10% **service** as well [amount of money you pay for being served by the waiter]. If service isn't **included**, it's normal to leave a **tip** [extra money you give to the waiter/waitress].

D

Ordering a meal

WAITER: **Are you ready to order?** [Have you decided what to eat?]

CUSTOMER: Yes, I think so. I'd like to start with the spicy prawns, and then **I'll have** the fillet steak, with French fries and a **mixed salad** [lettuce with other vegetables].

WAITER: How would you like your steak? (**Rare, medium or well-done?**)

CUSTOMER: **Medium**, please. And I'd like some mineral water as well.

WAITER: **Still or sparkling?**

CUSTOMER: Er, sparkling.

Common mistakes

I'll have the steak. (NOT ~~I take~~ the steak.)

Exercises

48.1 Put the words into the correct columns. Write titles for the other two groups.

rare	starter	mini-bar	sparkling	main course
room service	medium	dessert	still	well-done
				safe

steak			water
rare			

48.2 Match the words on the left with the words on the right.

1 service	☒	a room
2 room	☐	b access
3 double	☐	c meal
4 three-course	☐	d conditioning
5 main	☐	e service
6 internet	☐	f TV
7 air	☐	g included
8 satellite	☐	h course



48.3 Complete the sentences.

- 1 Have you booked a room?
- 2 Could you first check in at _____?
- 3 Do you want a single or a _____?
- 4 Does the price include _____?
- 5 I _____ the soup, and then the fish for my main course.
- 6 The hotel _____ included internet access, 24-hour reception and a restaurant.
- 7 Service wasn't included, so I left a 10% _____.
- 8 The hotel is in the _____ of the town, close to all the main attractions.
- 9 Would you like a _____ salad with your main _____?
- 10 At the end of your _____ at a hotel, you normally have to _____ out by midday.

48.4 Rewrite the sentences on the left starting with the words given. Keep a similar meaning.

1 I was able to use the Internet.	I had internet <u>access</u> .
2 Did you book a table?	Did you make a _____?
3 The hotel was fully booked.	There were no rooms _____.
4 You don't pay extra for service.	Service is _____.
5 Did you book it before you went?	Did you book it in _____?
6 Is there somewhere to leave the car?	Do you have _____?
7 Have you decided what you want to eat?	Are you ready _____?

48.5 Over to you

You are staying in a hotel in your own country. Are these facilities important to you? Why? / Why not?

mini-bar	24-hour room service	air conditioning	satellite TV
internet access	parking	restaurant	a personal safe